Do it again and help me understand, Catra.

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/51077512.

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Adora & Catra (She-Ra), Adora - Relationship

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Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Horde Prime (She-Ra), Entrapta (She-Ra)

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Do it again and help me understand, Catra.

by MicanPie

Summary

Catra had tried everything to keep Adora down on Earth, but when all failed, she used her last remaining hope and pressed a kiss onto Adora's trembling lips. Expecting forgiveness, Catra braced herself for the worst - yet what came out of Adora's lips was unexpected -

Notes

See the end of the work for notes

“Do it again.”

A quiet sob escaped her throat, bubbling just like the oxygen escaping the last bit of a dying body, burrowing to the surface and popping as soon as it reached its destination. Tears streamed down her face like a waterfall, crashing against each other on her chin and fell down. It was ugly, disgustingly human, but it was her and her tears. Her sorrow of what she is giving away if she lets Catra walk away. If she chooses to go with Heaven. And god knows - Adora will go with Heaven.

“Please, Catra, *do it again*.”

‘Kiss me again, do it again, please help me understand just like you’ve helped me understand oh so long ago this feeling I’ve been yearning for; help me feel and help me understand this hunger I craved for, as you did so long ago back then.’

’*Do it again.*’ That’s what her words meant. The yearning, the hunger, desperation; it all meant the same thing, it all led to the exact same ending, one which they were already heading towards before Heaven cast its angels down to Hell; it was always going to end like this, didn't it? It was inevitable. No, it was ineffable. She had the power, her delicate blonde hair falling messily over her face and framing the gorgeous blue eyes that stung like needle, trying its best to sew back together what had already begun to fray. What had already been - tethered.

Already silent, Catra dared to not mutter a word again in fear that the already fraying knot would pop off and she’d lose the single thread which had been tying them together for centuries. Eons. For - the entirety of existence.

Adora’s mind was set, wasn’t it. It was set the moment the opportunity was given to her on a silver platter, handed to her. It was always going to be her. Why her? Why not someone else? Why did it have to be her? All Catra ever did was ask questions,

did she not? So why. Why even now, she couldn't receive answers while her world is slipping right through her fingers?

Why? It was always why. It might forever remain a 'why'.

With a quivering lip, Catra pulled Adora by her helm and kissed her lips, the gentle and fragile touch of her skin pressing against her own. It wasn't as desperate and pulling as before. It was different. Softer, bargaining but softer, a quiet plea, like an ocean which had accepted the storm was beginning to roam and that it will hit the shore line with a thunder crash, leaving behind nothing more but the emptiness over its wake.

Adora felt it. She felt it all throughout her corporal existence. It stung, it ached, it bruised her existence and her soul, but she could never really accept it for what it is, can she? Yet still she clung onto Catra's arms, gripping them before wrapping her own around her, pulling her closer.

Pulling away was painful. It was painful because the two already knew what it meant. This was the end, or perhaps a beginning neither were ready to face just yet. Adora slumped in Catra's arms, her face burying deep into the demon's shoulder and sobbed.

"I can't stay." Adora whimpered. "I - I have to go."

'Why? Why do you have to leave, why leave me? Why leave me behind and go with those who have hurt you? What have they done that I haven't? Where did I make a mistake? Why not me? Why not me?'

Catra wished she could ask all of these questions. She wished to make Adora second guess herself, make her stay, help her see what Catra had seen so many times before. But she couldn't. Adora had made up her mind.

A shaky breath escaped her lips as everything within her begged herself, her own mind and existence and corporeal form, it begged to make Adora stay.

“I know.” Catra whispered, her own heart broken and distraught.

She knew. She already knew this was how this tale would end, how they’d fall and crash and burn.

She already knew. It hurt that she knew.

“You always do. You always have to do what’s right.” Catra tried, but her words were cold and numb. “Why does it have to be *you*, Adora?”

Adora paused. Her eyes were stinging and her face was burning red from the emotions. She couldn’t answer. It was as if the words were just on the tip of your tongue yet something was keeping them just on the edge, at the brim of her lips. She couldn’t - no, she *didn’t want to* answer.

Catra bit her own lip. There was no need to answer, because it was already known. Catra knew.

“I’ll - wait for you to return, right here.” She said with a heavy heart. It’s not what she wished to say. But that's what she had to say. She had to let Adora know, otherwise, Adora won’t ever come back, won’t she? Maybe that was just wishful thinking.

Pulling away from their embrace, Catra looked away and dared not to turn around to see her Angel’s face coated in tears and snot. She dared not to question her own decision. Adora might’ve made up her mind, but Catra had done so way before Adora, the moment she knew that God herself would dare to destroy everything she loved. Even now, she dared not to think of what God had taken away from her again, what God had done, as Adora had slipped through her fingers, going with the wind. The demon dared to not turn around as she opened the Bookshop doors and slipped outside where there was so much noise. So much noise. There was so much noise. It was so loud.

With a quivering breath, Adora wiped her eyes and pressed her fingers against her lips, clinging, longing, yearning. As quickly as she held onto that feeling she wiped it away and turned her head

back when the door of the Bookshop opened again, bringing in Metatron - he liked to call himself 'Prime' nowadays, didn't he?

"Well, what was her answer?" Prime asked, holding on a cold smile.

Adora had to pull herself together. She was to become a Supreme Archangel, they are not known to cry over things like these, over a Demon - Oh, just thinking those words burned harsher than she could imagine Hell to feel. Adora sniffled quietly and wiped her eyes clean, turning around and looking rather disheveled, but she had to put herself together.

"She uh - she declined the offer." Said Adora with a wavering voice.

Prime clicked his tongue and sighed, putting on a face that was supposed to be read as disappointment, perhaps he was genuinely disappointed.

"Shame. She always asked questions, that one, always going her own way, never following the light of the Almighty." Prime shook his head, sighing deeply again, before looking up at Adora, who was not looking back at him. She was looking at the window.

She hoped to see Catra again.

"Well, that is a shame, but since her mind is set, I guess all is to do is to leave. Is there anything you'd like to take with you, Adora?"

Adora hesitated. Yes, she hesitated. After everything, there was a sense of trepidation running through her as if leaving would mean to abandon everything. The world, the bookshop, Catra.

"I - well- " Adora looked at Prime, then around her bookshop, giving a weak smile. All of her memories are here; she wasn't ever smart, even if people assumed she was, she simply loved to own books that had a heavy Earthly tune to them, it helped her understand humans and their ways of thinking through words. To

leave the Bookshop would mean to leave the humanity she had grown to love. To leave now, would mean to leave it all behind, and with it, Catra.

Could she do it?

“What about the Bookshop?” Adora gestured around her, stepping closer towards her desk and near the window, wishing to see Catra again. Maybe if she saw her she could -

“Ah yes, your Bookshop. Worry not, I had already entrusted it to Entrapta.” Prime smiled, gesturing towards the outside window on the opposite of Adora, where the purple-haired Angel waved at her enthusiastically.

“Worry not, I am sure she will take great care of it.”

Adora still hesitated. It was crushing her, suffocating, meddling in her mind and boggling it all into an incomprehensible mess.

“Anything you’d like to take from it? Maybe a souvenir?” Asked Prime, gesturing around them.

Catra. She wished she could bring Catra, even if only as a Demon.

“I-“ Adora looked through the window and out to the streets near her desk, before looking back at Prime. A smile forced itself onto her face. She set her mind the moment she heard the offer, she could save everyone, set it all straight. Because what is happening in Heaven isn’t right, so she has to fix it. For Catra. For the world.

And if it’s for the two things she loved the most, the two most important things, then she will use this opportunity and go with Prime. One day she will use the sword she gave away long ago to cut open her guts and let them spill, bleed out, and let them expose themselves to everything. She will let it bore and she will let herself be vulnerable. But that was not now nor here. Now she had to pretend. It was all for the two things she loves the most.

No - it was for one person she loved the most. It was all for Catra. It will be for them.

"Nothing at all." Adora said with a smile. It was a forced smile and it stung her cheeks.

This is for Catra. This is for them.

As the two walked outside, leaving the Bookshop empty for the time being, Catra stood by her car, arm placed against its hood, and stared. She said she would wait, but she knew it would hurt more than anything. There was no doubt in her mind that as Adora and Prime spoke, there was a question lingering on Adora's lips, one that Catra had the answers to already. 'What is it exactly that Heaven is planning?'

Why, something big, something that they call;

" - 'The second coming'." Prime spoke as he stepped into the elevator, looking at Adora expectedly as she held his thumb against the button.

The Angel turned to look in the direction the Demon stood, seeing her between the people who went past and on with their day, living normally, unaware of what is happening to the two beings that once saved the world from the end. They stared for a second, and then another, before Adora tore her eyes away from Catra and looked towards the elevator. And again, she smiled. Catra stayed there, the burning sensation within her sizzling away, eating her heart with an ache that hurt worse than the fall, like a burning sulfur seeping its way right into her soul and turning what was once a heart into ash. She promised to wait, but it hurt to watch the Angel leave.

'Oh Adora, you idiot.' Catra thought to herself, as she felt her teeth clench harder. She wished she could've done more.

But… Was there anything she could've done more?

Catra swallowed back her tears and looked around, before taking her own step and getting into her car, shutting the doors and turning the engine on.

With a sputter it quietly roared to life and with it, so did the radio.

'-There were angels dining at the Ritz
And a nightingale sang in Berkeley Squa-"

With a frown, Catra turned the radio off. She didn't wish to hear it now, not now. They were not going to dine at the Ritz, and there were no Nightingales.

'No Nightingales'. No 'us'. There cannot be an 'us' until Adora realises what Catra was aware of.

As Catra drove off and Adora rode the elevator, the two realised a horrifying realisation: no matter what they did, no matter the choices they made, this was all going to lead to the same ending, it was always going to be that way, because it was already written out. They danced around each other for so long that there was never going to be an option, a choice, where they didn't end up apart. And there was nothing that either one of them could've done.

Nothing at all.

…. That is, of course, unless something were to happen.

Somewhere in the distance, a small bird landed on top of a branch just near the Bookshop that Entrapta had entered, cocking its head around, before it let out a soft chirp.

It did not sing, but the Nightingale *did* chirp once, before flying away from the Bookshop and into the Horizon.

End Notes

This is my first fanfic and I don't expect anyone to really see it. But I had this idea for a while and I KNOW someone else must've already done it before me. Nevertheless, I don't read many fanfics so if there is one and it is similar to the one I wrote, I apologise!

Also it is incredibly short and written within a span of an hour, so it might be flawed and a little weirdly written, but I hope you enjoy the glimpse into my little AU headcanon!

There might be more to come from me, I am working on a fix-it-fic which I hope to have approximately 50k words, but we'll see how that works! And no, it's not another crossover fic, this time it is simply Good Omens and nothing else. Hope to see you then, and thank you for reading!

Please drop by the archive and comment to let the author know if you enjoyed their work!